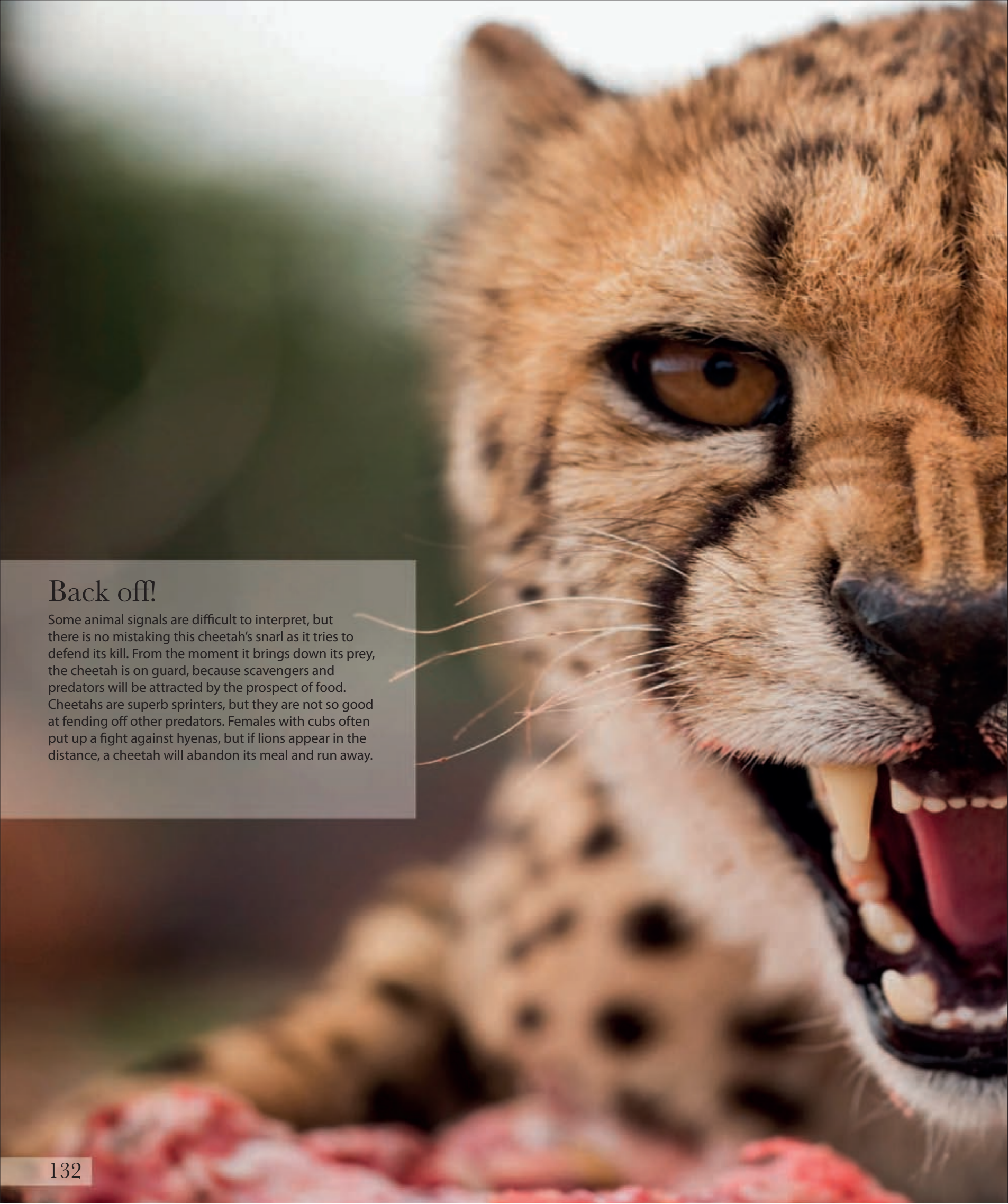




Back off!

Some animal signals are difficult to interpret, but there is no mistaking this cheetah's snarl as it tries to defend its kill. From the moment it brings down its prey, the cheetah is on guard, because scavengers and predators will be attracted by the prospect of food. Cheetahs are superb sprinters, but they are not so good at fending off other predators. Females with cubs often put up a fight against hyenas, but if lions appear in the distance, a cheetah will abandon its meal and run away.